and would defend it. If they are able to do this efficiently, the people of Soviet Union will forgive them many mistakes.

It appears that the Indian agency missed Alexei Kosygin who died in 1980. As chairman of the Council of Ministers of the Soviet Union, Kosygin was instrumental in promoting friendly ties between the Indians and the Soviets. His statement, 'Let friendship between the Soviet Union and India grow and strengthen' in the presence of Prime Minister Indira Gandhi in January 1968 in Delhi was seen as a message to Pakistan and China. When there were murmurs in the corridors of power that the Soviets were ready to supply arms and ammunition to Pakistan and the issue was taken up by the opposition leaders in the Indian Parliament, both Indira Gandhi and Kosygin denied that the friendly nation had made any such move. A R&AW report highlighted that Kosygin's death in October 1980 provided 'lonely eminence' to Brezhnev, but added that Brezhnev had no future.

The intelligence analysis also deciphered the thinking behind the various factions that were contenders for Brezhnev's position. The West was apprehensive of an army takeover after Brezhnev's demise, with the Defence Minister Dmitry Ustinov as the ruler. However, the R&AW analyst cited precedents of politicians prevailing over generals and refuted this claim. The analysts were certain that the army would not rule the Soviet Union. The report said:

The present ruling group very roughly consists of (a) the large Ukraine group (Dnipropetrovsk Mafia) each one of whom owes loyalty to Brezhnev, (b) A small Leningrad group, of which Kosygin earlier and today Romonov are the representatives. Leningrad has always been the outcast in the power struggles